Bond Paddle Sports: Marketing Strategy and Plan

Nov 5, 2026 · @Jackson Peter · Bond Safari Paddle Sports Pvt Ltd · aligned to financial model V03

Executive summary

The job marketing has to do. Model V03 needs about 33,000 paddlers in FY28 and about 99,000 by FY31, plus about 7,100 Academy learners. That is roughly 1 in 260 of the 25.9 million visits Kerala recorded in 2025. The demand exists. The task is to reach the right visitors at the right waters, at a cost the 19% site cost budget can carry.

The strategy in five moves

1. **Win Kerala first.** 68% of Kerala's domestic visits (17.1 million) are Keralites travelling within the state. Residents and weekend trippers from Kochi, Thiruvananthapuram and Kozhikode fill the shoulder months and weekdays that tourists leave empty. They are also the cheapest to reach, through Instagram, WhatsApp, schools and colleges, and the Bond Membership pass.
2. **Own the sunrise.** Houseboat, resort and homestay guests are already on the water at dawn. Sell to them through the operators who host them, on commission, with nothing stored at their premises.
3. **Be found by foreign visitors before they arrive.** The UK, US, Germany, France and Australia send about 363,000 visitors a year to Kerala, and they choose activities on Google, Tripadvisor and GetYourGuide. Ranking first for "kayaking in Kerala" and keeping a 4.7+ rating at every site matters more than any advertisement.
4. **Turn corporate Kochi into a year-round customer.** Team paddle races, offsite add-ons and CSR clean-up paddles fill weekdays and the monsoon. Kochi's new convention capacity at Bolgatty makes the city a growing MICE destination.
5. **Make every paddler a member, and every member a learner.** One pass works at all 19 sites, and the Academy ladder leads from a taster to Paddle UK courses. Repeat customers cost almost nothing to acquire.

Targets (aligned to model V03)

	FY28	FY29	FY31
Operating sites	7	14	19
Paddlers	32,800	61,800	99,300
Academy learners	1,670	3,580	7,130
Revenue (₹ Cr)	6.40	12.06	20.24
Share of bookings direct (web, WhatsApp, walk-in, members)	35%	40%	45%
Average Google and Tripadvisor rating	4.6+	4.7+	4.7+

Budget. Marketing and channel costs sit inside the model's 19% site variable cost and the Academy's 15% acquisition allowance on professional courses, so no extra funding is needed. We propose about 4.5% of site revenue for marketing, plus the Academy allowance. **That is about ₹35 lakh in FY28, rising to about ₹1.1 Cr in FY31.** On top of that, channel commissions of about 8% of site revenue are paid per sale. The discipline is to keep OTA bookings, which cost 20–30% each, to no more than 15% of the total.

What could go wrong

- **Promising more than a small team can deliver.** One serious incident or a run of poor reviews would undo the brand faster than any campaign can build it.
- **Cross-selling between Bond companies.** Cross-selling with bondsafarikovalam.com must run on written, arm's-length terms approved by the investor director.
- **Influencer disclosure rules.** Influencer content must follow ASCI's disclosure rules.
- **The Muziris opening dates.** The dates Bond holds differ from public reports, so they must be checked before they appear in any marketing.

1. Where we start, and what marketing must deliver

What exists today.

- **Muziris.** Two sites are trading, Kottapuram and North Paravur (Thattukadavu Jetty), under the Muziris Projects concession.
- **Kovalam.** The Kovalam hub and Academy campus open in FY27.
- **The Bond Safari brand.** It is known at Kovalam, and bondsafarikovalam.com already sells scuba and parasailing.
- **Owned digital assets.** The board approved bondpaddlesports.com and @bondpaddlesports. A shared booking engine with loyalty and shop is being built by the in-house web team.
- **Partnerships.** Talks with Paddle UK and ASAP are under way.

What the plan needs, year by year (model V03, base case)

	FY27 (Jan–Mar)	FY28	FY29	FY30	FY31	FY33
Sites open	3	7	14	17	19	19
Paddlers	2,900	32,800	61,800	82,000	99,300	119,300
Academy learners	230	1,670	3,580	5,580	7,130	8,010
Site revenue (₹ lakh)	50	433	787	1,031	1,212	1,427
Academy revenue (₹ lakh)	28	159	328	510	646	726
Shop revenue (₹ lakh)	7	48	92	133	165	197
Corporate and event revenue in site revenue (₹ lakh)	15	30	45	60	70	80

Marketing objectives

1. **Volume.** Deliver the paddler and learner numbers above at every site, by month, within the first 24 months of each opening.
2. **Mix.** Grow direct bookings (website, WhatsApp, walk-in and members) from 35% in FY28 to 45% by FY31. Hold OTA bookings at or below 15%.
3. **Fill the empty months.** Lift June–September volume to at least 35% of a peak month through residents, corporates, schools and monsoon Academy courses. Without this, fixed staff costs sit idle for a third of the year.
4. **Reputation.** Hold an average rating of 4.7 or more on Google and Tripadvisor at every site, with a response to every review within 48 hours.
5. **Repeat and ladder.** By FY31, 20% of paddlers are repeat customers or members, and 7% of first-time paddlers go on to an Academy course.
6. **Cost.** Keep marketing and channel costs within the 19% site variable budget and the Academy's 15% acquisition allowance.

Why the empty months matter. The model's EBITDA turns positive only in FY29, and the lowest month-end cash is ₹26 lakh in October 2027, after the first monsoon. Marketing that moves even 10% of volume into June–September does more for cash than anything spent in December.

2. The market and our audiences

Kerala's visitor base, 2025 (Kerala Tourism Statistics 2025)

Source	Visits in 2025	Growth vs 2024	Notes
Keralites travelling within Kerala	17,123,523	—	68% of all domestic visits
Other Indian states	about 7,934,800	—	Tamil Nadu 2.81 M, Karnataka 1.62 M, Maharashtra 0.77 M, Andhra Pradesh 0.45 M, Gujarat 0.38 M, Telangana 0.31 M, Delhi 0.30 M, Uttar Pradesh 0.22 M, West Bengal 0.20 M
All domestic	**25,058,366**	+12.6%	
Foreign	**821,999**	+11.3%	UK 122,137; USA 107,613; Oman 65,132; Germany 49,125; France 47,008; Malaysia 43,692; Australia 37,238; Maldives 32,324; Saudi Arabia 31,593; UAE 26,255

The state counts visits recorded at registered accommodation. Residents on day trips, and visitors staying with friends, family or in unregistered homestays, are not counted. For paddling, which locals can do on a free morning, this hidden market matters.

Audience map

We market to nine core segments and three opportunistic ones. The paddler shares are FY31 targets, totalling about 99,300 paddlers.

#	Segment	Who they are	Size signal	What they want	Priority	FY31 share of paddlers	Typical spend
1	**Native residents**	People living within an hour of a site: Kochi, Thiruvananthapuram, Kozhikode, Kollam, Kannur	Kerala's three biggest metro areas sit next to our hubs	Weekend fun, fitness, something new near home; repeat visits	1	20%	₹600–900 a session; membership
2	**Keralite holidaymakers**	Keralites on short breaks in another district, often families	17.1 M intra-state visits	Safe family activities, photos, value	1	15%	₹700–1,000
3	**Domestic tourists from other states**	Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Delhi; couples, families and friend groups	7.9 M visits	A memorable backwater or beach experience; easy booking in English or Hindi	1	28%	₹900–1,400
4	**Foreign independent travellers (FITs)**	UK, US, German, French and Australian travellers on their own itineraries at Kovalam, Varkala, Kochi, Alappuzha and Kumarakom	About 363,000 visits from these five markets	Authenticity, certified guides, safety, online booking, reviews	1	9%	₹1,100–2,200
5	**Foreign tour**	Group tours booked through	Most of Kerala's	A reliable slot in a	2	3%	Net rate ₹800–

#	Segment	Who they are	Size signal	What they want	Priority	FY31 share of paddlers	Typical spend
	groups	UK, European and US operators and Indian DMCs	foreign arrivals pass through DMCs	fixed itinerary; net rates; insurance			1,200
6	**Houseboat, resort and homestay guests**	Overnight guests of every nationality on Vembanad, Ashtamudi, Valiyaparamba and at beach resorts	About 800 houseboats on Vembanad alone	Something to do at sunrise or sunset, close by	1	(counted in segments 2–5)	₹1,000–1,800
7	**MICE and corporate**	Kochi IT parks and corporates; incentive groups; conference delegates at Bolgatty and other Kochi venues	Kochi is building out as a MICE destination; Kerala ran India's first Wedding and MICE Conclave in 2025	Team-building with a story, logistics handled, invoices and GST	1	6%	₹1,200–2,500 per head
8	**Schools, colleges and youth**	Schools and colleges in our districts; NCC, NSS, scouts; local youth	The Academy's school tier targets 2,500 students a year by FY31	Water safety, skills, certificates, careers	2	7%	₹400–700 a session; ₹9,000 a student-year (Academy)
9	**Academy learners and aspiring**	Adults and young people who want Paddle UK	7,130 learners in FY31	Recognised certificates, a path to	1	(Academy)	Course prices from the 2027 rate

#	Segment	Who they are	Size signal	What they want	Priority	FY31 share of paddlers	Typical spend
	guides	qualifications and paddling jobs		paid work			card
10	**NRIs and the Gulf diaspora home on holiday**	Kerala families from the Gulf home for summer school holidays, Onam and December	The Gulf is Kerala's largest diaspora market (figures not verified here)	Family outings during the visit home, which often falls in the monsoon	2	5%	₹700–1,000
11	**Cruise passengers at Kochi**	International cruise passengers on half-day shore excursions	Kochi cruise season runs roughly October–May	Short, safe, close to port, sold through ship agents	3	1%	Net rate via agents
12	**Destination wedding guests**	Guest groups at Kerala weddings	Kerala is promoting itself for weddings and MICE	A group activity the day before the wedding	3	1%	Group packages
	Unassigned and other					5%	

What this map tells us

- **Two-thirds of the plan rests on Indians** (segments 1, 2, 3 and 10, about 68% of paddlers). Kerala Tourism's own numbers point to this, so most of the budget goes into Malayalam, English and Hindi digital marketing aimed at Kerala and South India.
- **Foreign visitors are fewer but worth more.** At 9% plus 3% of paddlers, they make about 18% of revenue, because they buy longer tours and lessons. They need reviews and OTA listings more than advertising.
- **MICE, schools and the diaspora fill the empty months.** The Gulf diaspora is home in June–August, corporates run offsites in the monsoon, and schools book term-time weekdays. Our marketing plan treats them as the cure for the monsoon dip, not as extras.

- **Each site has its own audience mix.**
    - Kovalam and Varkala lean foreign and SUP.
    - Alappuzha and Kumarakom lean houseboat and resort.
    - Kochi's island spokes lean resident and corporate.
    - Muziris leans heritage and families.
    - Malabar sites lean residents and Gulf diaspora.

3. Positioning and brand

Positioning statement. For anyone in Kerala who wants to get onto the water, Bond Paddle Sports is the paddling company with certified guides, proper kit and a rescue boat on every trip, across 19 of Kerala's best waters. Unlike a hired boat or a roadside kayak rental, every Bond session is run to the Paddle UK standard. Every session can also lead somewhere: a membership, a course, even a career.

Brand idea: "Kerala, paddled properly."

- *Kerala*: the waters people already love, including backwaters, estuaries, beaches, lakes and rivers, seen at paddle height.
- *Paddled*: active, quiet and close to nature, not a motorboat ride.
- *Properly*: certified guides, safety and respect for the water and the villages. This is our difference, and it is what a parent, a corporate HR team or a foreign traveller needs to hear first.

Proof points we can say in every channel

1. Paddle UK-qualified guides, a rescue boat on standby and a life jacket on every guest. Say this only once the Paddle UK agreement is signed; until then, say "trained to Paddle UK standards".
2. Registered with KATPS, the state's adventure tourism body.
3. 19 sites, one booking, one membership.
4. Part of Bond Group, with 25 years of water sports in Kerala.
5. The Academy: from first paddle to professional qualification.
6. A light footprint: no motors at our sites, a litter pick on every trip, and guides hired from the local community.

Messages by audience

Audience	Lead message	Tone
Native residents	"Your backwater, your weekend. Sunrise paddles 20 minutes from home."	Local, friendly, Malayalam-first
Keralite and domestic families	"Safe, guided, unforgettable. Kids from 8 paddle with a guide."	Reassuring
Domestic young groups	"Sunset SUP. The photo everyone asks about."	Energetic, social
Foreign FITs	"See the real Kerala at paddle height, with certified local guides."	Authentic, understated
Tour operators and	"A reliable, insured, Paddle UK-standard activity at	Professional

Audience	Lead message	Tone
DMCs	19 locations, on net rates."	
MICE and corporate	"Team-building that actually moves: races, rescues and a clean-up paddle for your CSR report."	Results-focused
Schools and parents	"Water safety first, then confidence on the water."	Responsible
Academy learners	"From first paddle to Paddle UK coach."	Aspirational, practical
Gulf diaspora	"Home for the holidays? Take the family paddling."	Warm, Malayalam

Brand architecture

- **Master brand:** Bond Paddle Sports (operated by Bond Safari Paddle Sports Pvt Ltd), shown as "a Bond Group company".
- **Sub-brands:**
    - Bond Paddle Academy, for courses;
    - Bond Membership, the group-wide loyalty pass;
    - the Bond shop.
- **Site names follow the water:** "Bond Paddle Sports, Kadamakkudy". They do not follow a resort or partner.
- **Partner co-branding:** Bond provides and runs the activity; the partner sells it. We do not put a partner's brand on our safety promise.

Language. Malayalam and English for Kerala audiences. English and Hindi for other states. English, with German and French landing pages by FY29, for Europe. Use Arabic only for Gulf family campaigns, and test it before committing.

4. Segment playbooks

Each playbook sets out the offer, price, channels, partners, timing and the numbers we hold ourselves to. Prices follow the destination reports and the 2027 rate card, and are inclusive of GST.

4.1 Native residents ("paddle near home")

- **Goal:** about 20,000 paddlers in FY31, of whom 30% come back at least three times a year.
- **Offer:**
    - **Sunrise and sunset sessions.** 90-minute weekday early-bird sessions at ₹600–700, open to everyone under the one-price policy.
    - **Weekend specials.** Weekend SUP yoga and moonlight paddles on full-moon nights, at sites where night rules allow.
    - **Monthly "paddle and pick" clean-ups.** Free for members.
    - **Bond Membership.** The Paddle Season Pass is offered at the first visit.
- **Channels:**
    - Instagram and YouTube Shorts in Malayalam;
    - WhatsApp Business broadcast lists by site;

    - a Google Business Profile for every site;
    - local FM and newspaper features at each launch;
    - residents' associations, gyms and running clubs;
    - apartment complexes near Kochi's island spokes.
- **Partners:** running and cycling clubs, CrossFit and yoga studios, corporate wellness teams and local influencers, with ASCI disclosure.
- **When:** all year. Push hardest in May, during school holidays, and from October to January. In the monsoon, push Academy pool tasters and WhatsApp alerts when the water is calm.
- **KPIs:**
    - share of paddlers with a Kerala PIN code;
    - repeat-visit rate;
    - membership conversion (target 8% of local first-timers);
    - WhatsApp list size (target 2,000 contacts per site by month 12).

4.2 Keralite holidaymakers and families

- **Goal:** about 15,000 paddlers in FY31.
- **Offer:**
    - **Family session.** 2 adults and 2 children, in double kayaks and a canoe, for ₹2,600–2,800.
    - **Birthday and school-holiday packages.**
    - **The "first paddle" certificate.** Children love it, and parents post it.
- **Channels:**
    - Facebook and Instagram ads targeted by district and life stage;
    - Google search ("things to do in Alappuzha with kids");
    - KSRTC budget-tourism and Kerala Tourism listings;
    - hotel and homestay front desks.
- **When:** April–May (school holidays), Onam (August–September), Christmas and New Year.
- **KPIs:** family bookings as a share of the total; cost per family booking (target ₹250 or less); rating from family reviews.

4.3 Domestic tourists from other states

- **Goal:** about 28,000 paddlers in FY31.
- **Source markets, in order:** Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh and Telangana, then Delhi and Gujarat.
- **Offer:**
    - **The signature experience at each site.** Sunrise canal paddle at Alappuzha, sunset SUP at Kovalam, Kappil lake at Varkala, the heritage paddle at Muziris.
    - **Two-site combos.** Pair a paddle with Bond Group activities, for example a Kovalam paddle with parasailing or a scuba discovery dive. These run on related-party terms (Section 12).
- **Channels:**
    - Google search and YouTube in English and Hindi, with Tamil and Kannada creatives for Chennai, Coimbatore and Bengaluru;
    - Instagram reels with travel creators from these cities;
    - listings on MakeMyTrip, Thrillophilia, Klook India and other domestic platforms;

    - Kerala Tourism's domestic roadshows;
    - corporate travel desks.
- **When:**
    - book-ahead campaigns 4–6 weeks before school holidays, long weekends, Diwali, Christmas and New Year;
    - always-on search in October–May.
- **KPIs:** booking share by state; cost per booking by channel; share booked more than 7 days ahead (target 40%, which smooths staffing).

4.4 Foreign independent travellers (FITs)

- **Goal:** about 9,000 paddlers in FY31, at the highest spend per head.
- **Source markets:** the UK, the US, Germany, France and Australia, plus Gulf expatriates of European origin.
- **Offer:**
    - **Half-day Kuttanad canal tour** with a village breakfast, ₹1,900.
    - **Sunrise bird paddle at Kumarakom**, December–February, ₹1,600.
    - **SUP lessons at Kovalam and Varkala.**
    - **Multi-day paddle journeys** (Kerala Paddle Trail) from FY29.
    - **Paddle UK courses for travellers who stay longer.**
- **Channels, in order of importance:**
    a. **Google Business Profile and Google Maps.** Most FITs search "kayaking near me".
    b. **Tripadvisor reviews.**
    c. **GetYourGuide and Viator listings**, capped at 15% of bookings because they charge 20–30% commission.
    d. **Our website** in English, with German and French pages.
    e. **Homestays, guesthouses and boutique hotels** on 10–12% commission, with QR code cards.
    f. **Travel bloggers and YouTubers** on hosted trips, with disclosure.
    g. **Lonely Planet and Rough Guides** research visits.
- **When:** the content and reviews must be live before foreign visitors arrive. Lists go live in August–September for the October–March season. Most bookings arrive within 3 days of the activity.
- **KPIs:**
    - Tripadvisor rank among outdoor activities in each town (target top 3 by month 12);
    - review count (target 100 per site in year one);
    - OTA share at or below 15%;
    - share of foreign paddlers buying a half day or longer.

4.5 Foreign tour groups and DMCs

- **Goal:** about 3,000 paddlers in FY31, plus reliable weekday volume.
- **Offer:**
    - **Net-rate activity packages.** Contracted rates 20–25% below retail, with guaranteed slots, group sizes of up to 24, and insurance and safety documents in a DMC pack.
    - **A Kerala Paddle Trail product** that tour operators can resell.

- **Channels:**
  - Kerala Travel Mart (held 24–27 September 2026; plan for the 2028 edition);
  - WTM London (3–5 November 2026; attend 2027 on the Kerala Tourism stand);
  - ITB Berlin (16–18 March 2027);
  - direct sales calls to the 30 biggest Kerala DMCs;
  - fam trips for DMC product managers;
  - listing in Kerala Tourism's activity directory.
- **KPIs:**
  - signed DMC contracts (target 15 by FY29);
  - net-rate revenue;
  - on-time delivery rate (target 99%).

4.6 Houseboat, resort and homestay guests

- **Goal:** the main sales channel at Alappuzha, Kumarakom, Ashtamudi, Poovar and Bekal. About 25% of paddlers come through partners by FY31.
- **Offer:**
  - **A sunrise or sunset paddle.** Pick-up from the houseboat or resort jetty by our rescue boat, where allowed.
  - **Simple partner economics.** 10–15% commission paid monthly, no kit stored at the partner, and our insurance.
- **Channels:**
  - partner sales kits: tent cards, QR codes and a WhatsApp booking line;
  - houseboat owners' associations;
  - quarterly partner meetings;
  - a "top partner" incentive.
- **KPIs:** active partners per site (target 20 at Alappuzha and 10 at Kumarakom); bookings per partner per month.

4.7 MICE and corporate

See Section 7.

4.8 Schools, colleges and youth

- **Goal:** about 7,000 paddlers on school and college trips in FY31, plus the Academy's school tier (2,500 student-years).
- **Offer:**
  - **Water safety and paddling day trips.** ₹400–700 per student, including a safety talk and certificate.
  - **School paddle clubs** with term-time weekly sessions.
  - **NCC, NSS and scouts partnerships.**
  - **Inter-school paddle regattas**, linked to the local snake-boat race culture.
- **Channels:**
  - principals' associations;
  - district education offices;
  - CBSE and ICSE school groups in Kochi, Thiruvananthapuram and Kozhikode;

    - parents' WhatsApp groups via the schools;
    - college tourism and physical education departments.
- **When:**
    - June–September weekdays, when schools are in session and tourists are few;
    - January–February, for annual trips.
- **KPIs:** schools signed; student sessions; conversion of students into Academy courses.

4.9 Academy learners and aspiring guides

- **Goal:** 1,670 learners in FY28, rising to 7,130 in FY31.
- **Offer:** the Paddle UK ladder, from Discover and Start Paddling to Paddlesport Leader, Coach and Tutor, priced from the 2027 rate card.
    - **For young people:** a free taster, a scholarship scheme run with Planet Ocean Foundation, and a guaranteed interview for guide jobs at Bond.
    - **For working adults:** weekend courses.
- **Channels:**
    - career fairs;
    - polytechnics and sports colleges;
    - KUFOS and fisheries schools;
    - search for "kayak instructor course India";
    - YouTube course content;
    - ASAP's channels;
    - alumni referrals, with a ₹1,000 credit.
- **KPIs:** learners; course completion; placement rate; acquisition cost within the 15% allowance.

4.10 NRIs and the Gulf diaspora home on holiday

- **Goal:** about 5,000 paddlers in FY31, concentrated in June–August, which are otherwise our weakest months.
- **Offer:**
    - **Monsoon family sessions** on sheltered waters on calm days;
    - **gift memberships** bought from the Gulf for family in Kerala;
    - **an Onam family package.**
- **Channels:**
    - Malayalam Facebook and Instagram ads geo-targeted to the UAE, Saudi Arabia, Oman, Qatar, Kuwait and Bahrain in May–June;
    - Gulf Malayali associations;
    - Gulf Malayalam radio and newspapers' Kerala pages.
- **KPIs:** monsoon-month paddlers; Gulf-origin bookings; gift membership sales.

4.11 Opportunistic: cruise passengers and wedding groups

- **Cruise passengers.** Offer a 2-hour Kochi island paddle, close to the cruise terminal, sold only through the ship's shore-excursion agents. Test it in one season before investing more.
- **Wedding groups.** Offer a pre-wedding group paddle and photo session, sold through the wedding planners who attend Kerala's Wedding and MICE Conclave.

- **Both** are low volume but high spend, and both need almost no marketing beyond agent relationships.

5. Product ladder, pricing and bundles

One price for everyone. Bond's policy is one price for national and international clients, with no difference by nationality. Discounts are therefore set by time, group size, frequency or membership, never by passport or residence. Marketing copy and partner rate sheets must follow this rule.

The ladder

Step	Product	Typical price	Purpose	Next step we sell
1. Try	45–60 minute taster, weekday early-bird or school session	₹400–700	Remove fear; volume in quiet hours	Guided tour, membership
2. Explore	90-minute to 2-hour guided paddle: sunrise, sunset, canal or SUP	₹900–1,200	The core product at every site	Signature tour, lesson
3. Signature	Half-day canal tour with breakfast, bird paddle, heritage paddle, moonlight paddle	₹1,600–2,200	Higher spend; reviews and photos	Membership, Paddle Trail
4. Learn	SUP lesson; Paddle UK Discover / Start Paddling	₹1,200 lesson; course prices per the 2027 rate card	Moves people into the Academy	Paddlesport Leader course
5. Belong	Bond Membership with a Paddle Season Pass, valid at all sites	Set within the Bond Membership programme	Repeat visits at near-zero acquisition cost	Courses, shop, group-wide benefits
6. Career	Paddlesport Leader, Coach and Tutor; guide jobs at Bond	Rate card	Staff pipeline and Academy revenue	Employment at Bond
Across	Shop: buoyancy aids, dry bags, apparel, paddles; collection at the jetty	Per shop range	About ₹1.65 Cr of revenue by FY31	Membership discount

Pricing rules for marketing

- **Time-based pricing, not a discount culture.** Weekday early-bird and monsoon prices are published and open to everyone. Avoid blanket "% off" campaigns that train customers to wait.

- **Price floors by product.** No 2-hour guided paddle sells below ₹800 in any channel, OTAs included. The DMC net rate is the lowest price anywhere.
- **Commission ceilings:**
    - partners (resorts, houseboats, homestays, hotel desks): 10–15%;
    - DMCs: a net rate 20–25% below retail;
    - OTAs: 20–30% charged by the platform, with listing prices equal to our website (rate parity);
    - affiliates and creators: 8–10%.
- **Group pricing.** For groups of 10 or more: 10% off. For 25 or more: a quoted package with a dedicated guide team.
- **Gift vouchers.** Sold online and through partners. They bring in cash early and make a natural Gulf-diaspora and corporate gift.

Bundles

Bundle	What's in it	Who it's for	Notes
Backwater Sunrise	Sunrise paddle plus breakfast at a partner homestay	FITs, couples	Alappuzha, Kumarakom, Munroe
Coast and Water	Kovalam SUP plus a scuba try-dive or parasail	Domestic young groups	Cross-sold with bondsafarikovalam.com on related-party terms
Heritage Paddle	Muziris paddle plus a heritage site visit	Families, schools	With Muziris Projects
Kerala Paddle Trail	3–5 days across 3–4 sites with homestays	Foreign FITs, DMCs	From FY29
Team Paddle Day	Races, a rescue challenge, lunch and a clean-up paddle	Corporates	Section 7
Learn-to-Lead	Discover course plus 3 guided sessions plus a membership	Residents, students	Academy funnel

6. Channel strategy

Target channel mix (share of paddler bookings)

Channel	FY28	FY31	Cost to us	Role
Direct: website and shared booking engine, WhatsApp, phone, walk-in, members	35%	45%	2–3% payment fees plus marketing	Cheapest; we own the customer data
Partners: houseboats, resorts,	25%	25%	10–15%	Sunrise and sunset

Channel	FY28	FY31	Cost to us	Role
homestays, hotel desks, tour desks			commission	volume at backwater sites
OTAs: GetYourGuide, Viator, Klook, MakeMyTrip, Thrillophilia	20%	15%	20–30% commission	Discovery for FITs and domestic tourists; cap it
B2B: DMCs, tour operators, corporates and MICE, schools	20%	15%	Net rates 20–25% below retail	Weekday and monsoon volume; group revenue

Partner and OTA commissions come to about 8% of site revenue in FY28. They fall to about 7% by FY31 as OTAs shrink to 15% of bookings. These commissions sit inside the model's 19% site variable cost, alongside payment fees, consumables, insurance and about 4.5% for marketing.

B2B net rates are a discount, not a commission. The reports' blended average prices already assume them. Taking commissions and net-rate discounts together, channels cost about 12% of gross bookings in FY28 and about 10% in FY31. This is why direct bookings matter: every 10 points moved from OTAs to direct adds about 2% to site margin.

Digital foundations (before every launch)

1. **Website and shared booking engine.**
    - **One engine** with loyalty and shop across all Bond sites, as in the website brief.
    - **Landing pages.** One per site, with live availability, in English and Malayalam first; Hindi next; German and French from FY29.
    - **Mobile and payments.** Mobile-first, with UPI, cards and international cards.
2. **Google.**
    - A Google Business Profile for every site, verified before opening, with real photos, opening hours and the booking link.
    - Google Ads on high-intent searches ("kayaking in Alappuzha", "SUP Kovalam", "things to do in Kochi").
    - Search engine optimisation: a content hub of guides to each water body.
3. **WhatsApp Business.**
    - A booking and reminder bot.
    - Broadcast lists by site.
    - Calm-water and weather alerts in the monsoon.
    - A review request sent 2 hours after each session.
4. **Reviews.** QR codes at the kiosk; guides trained to ask for a review; replies within 48 hours. Every negative review triggers a safety and service check.
5. **Photo and video.** Free photos for every guest, shared by WhatsApp with the branded hashtag #PaddleKerala. This turns every customer into content.

Social and content

- **Instagram and Reels** are the main social channel for domestic audiences. Post 4 times a week per hub, including weekly guide-introduction posts, which build trust.

- **YouTube.** Long-form water-body guides, Academy course explainers and safety videos. These also win search traffic.
- **Facebook** for families and Gulf diaspora targeting.
- **LinkedIn** for corporate and MICE buyers, and for Academy careers.
- **Content pillars:**
    - the water and its wildlife;
    - local people and villages;
    - safety and skills;
    - members' stories;
    - conservation through Planet Ocean Foundation.

Creators and influencers

- **Each season, host 10–15 creators per hub.**
    - Mid-size travel and outdoor creators from Kerala, Bengaluru, Chennai and Mumbai.
    - Two or three international travel creators a year.
- **Payment.** Pay in hosted experiences plus a performance fee on tracked bookings, rather than large flat fees.
- **Compliance.** Every brief requires ASCI-compliant disclosure ("#ad" or "#collab" upfront, plus the platform's paid-partnership label) and no claims about safety statistics.

B2B trade

- **DMC programme.** A rate sheet, a safety and insurance pack, a 24-hour group booking desk and fam trips. Target the 30 largest Kerala inbound operators first.
- **Trade fairs, through Kerala Tourism or KTM Society stands:**
    - Kerala Travel Mart (September 2028 edition);
    - WTM London (November);
    - ITB Berlin (March);
    - Arabian Travel Market (April–May), for Gulf outbound and diaspora travel.
- **Hotels and resorts.** Partner agreements with commission, a staff fam paddle, and quarterly top-seller rewards.

Public partners

- **Bodies to work with:**
    - Kerala Tourism and the district DTPCs, for activity listings, campaigns and festival slots;
    - KTDC properties as sales points;
    - Muziris Projects, for heritage promotion;
    - the Responsible Tourism Mission, for village experiences.
- **The approach.** Government-facing proposals go through the agreed route for such work, and through open processes (Section 12).

PR and events

- **Launch PR at every site:**
    - a launch day with the local MLA or panchayat president, run as a public event;
    - a free community paddle;

    - local press and Malayalam TV.
- **Signature events:**
    - **the Bond Paddle Kerala series:** four regattas a year, one per hub;
    - **an annual Vembanad clean-up paddle** with Planet Ocean Foundation;
    - **Academy graduation days.**
- **Festival presence.** The Beypore water festival, the Nehru Trophy and Champions Boat League race days, and Onam. Because KATPS co-organises some of these festivals, Bond's role must be arranged at arm's length (Section 12).

CRM and loyalty

- **One customer record across all sites and Bond companies,** with consent captured at booking under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023.
- **Automated journeys:**
    - a thank-you and review request;
    - a membership offer within 7 days;
    - an Academy taster offer after the third visit;
    - birthday and season-opening messages;
    - a win-back offer at 6 months.
- **Bond Membership** is the loyalty engine across Bond Group companies. Its value grows with every new site, and the cost of rewards must be charged between Bond companies on written terms.

Cross-selling within Bond Group

- **What to cross-sell.** Bondsafarikovalam.com scuba and parasailing customers are offered a paddle, and paddlers are offered those activities.
- **The terms.** This is valuable, but it moves customers and money between companies with different shareholders. It must run on:
    - a written cross-referral agreement;
    - market-rate referral commissions;
    - a shared-data agreement;
    - approval by the investor director.
- **Reporting.** Report the referral flows both ways each quarter.

7. MICE and corporate programme

Why it matters.

- **The money.** The model carries about ₹15–80 lakh a year of event revenue, plus a 15% B2B uplift on site sales, and corporate business is the biggest part of both.
- **The timing.** Corporates buy on weekdays and in the monsoon, which is exactly when leisure demand is lowest.
- **The market.** Kochi is a fast-growing MICE destination. The Lulu convention centre and the Grand Hyatt at Bolgatty sit 15 minutes from our Kochi island spokes, and Kerala Tourism ran India's first Wedding and MICE Conclave in Kochi in August 2025.

Target: about 6,000 corporate and MICE paddlers in FY31 and about ₹80 lakh to ₹1 Cr of revenue, including events, about 5% of group revenue.

Products

Product	Format	Group size	Indicative price	Best sites
Team Paddle Day	Safety briefing, skills, relay races, a rescue challenge, lunch, awards	20–120	₹1,800–2,500 per head	Kadamakkudy, Kumbalangi, Muziris, Alappuzha
Offsite add-on	2-hour sunrise or sunset paddle for conference or offsite delegates	10–60	₹1,200–1,500 per head	Kochi, Kumarakom, Kovalam, Bekal
CSR clean-up paddle	Litter and hyacinth clean-up with Planet Ocean Foundation, plus an impact report	20–200	Costed per programme; CSR-eligible elements through the Foundation	All backwater sites
Leadership on the water	Half-day facilitated programme: navigation, decisions, debrief	8–24	₹4,000–6,000 per head	Kovalam campus, Kochi
Incentive experiences	Private sunset SUP, moonlight paddle, Kerala Paddle Trail	10–40	Quoted	Varkala, Kumarakom, Alappuzha
Corporate memberships	Passes for staff wellness programmes	25–500 staff	Volume pricing within Bond Membership	Near Kochi, Thiruvananthapuram and Kozhikode IT parks

Who we sell to

- **IT parks:** Infopark and SmartCity (Kochi), Technopark (Thiruvananthapuram) and Cyberpark (Kozhikode). Approach HR, employee engagement and admin teams.
- **Corporate offices:** banks, insurers and pharmaceutical firms with Kerala regional offices.
- **Event intermediaries:**
    - event management companies and destination management companies with MICE desks;
    - hotel sales teams at Bolgatty, Marriott, Crowne Plaza, Taj and resort groups;
    - the Kochi convention bureau and the organisers of Kerala's Wedding and MICE Conclave.

How we sell

1. **One corporate sales lead.** Based at the Ernakulam hub from FY28 and paid partly on commission.
2. **A MICE kit.**
    - A deck and a menu of formats.
    - Safety, insurance and permit documents.
    - GST invoicing.
    - Photos and video for the client's internal communications.
    - A post-event impact report covering the CSR clean-up totals.
3. **Hotel partnerships.**
    - Venue sales teams add our formats to their conference packages, earning 10% commission.
    - We run a free fam paddle for their sales staff each season.
4. **Visibility.**
    - LinkedIn content and case studies.
    - Two showcase "corporate regattas" a year that invite HR heads.
5. **Monsoon formats.**
    - Sheltered-water and pool-based team challenges.
    - Academy safety workshops.
    - These are sold as "monsoon offsites" with rain-date flexibility.

KPIs

- Corporate accounts signed (target 25 by FY29 and 60 by FY31).
- Revenue per event.
- Repeat bookings (target 40%).
- Share of corporate revenue earned in June–September (target 35%).

8. Site launch playbook and hub priorities

Opening order (model V03)

Year	Sites opening	Marketing focus
FY27 (Jan–Mar 2027)	Kovalam hub and Academy; Muziris Kottapuram and North Paravur already trading	Build the brand at Kovalam with foreign FITs and domestic tourists; residents and families at Muziris
FY28	Kadamakkudy, Kumarakom, Alappuzha–Punnamada; Poovar resort pilot from October 2027	Ernakulam hub launch; houseboat and resort partner networks; first corporate programme
FY29	Kumbalangi, Varkala–Kappil, Munroe Island, Vellayani, Cherai satellite; Kozhikode lean hub with Beypore and Kodenchery	Second wave in the south; Malabar launch aimed at residents and the Gulf diaspora; Academy monsoon campus

Year	Sites opening	Marketing focus
FY30	Akalapuzha, Bekal–Kottappuram, Parassinikkadavu pop-up; northern depot	Bekal resort cluster; north Kerala residents
FY31	Pookode (DTPC), Valiyaparamba	Wayanad's domestic tourists; Valiyaparamba trail product

The launch playbook (every site)

When	Actions
90 days before opening	Site page and Google Business Profile drafted; photo and video shoot; partner list (resorts, houseboats, homestays, schools) built; panchayat and community briefing; KATPS registration filed (with the MD's recusal)
60 days before	Partner agreements signed; WhatsApp group and list started; launch date set with local officials; creator visits booked
30 days before	Pre-sale at a launch price on the website; a soft-opening invitation to residents, partners' staff and press; DMC and OTA listings submitted
Opening week	A free community paddle and a clean-up; local press, Malayalam TV and FM; creators on site; partners' staff paddle free
Days 1–90	Target 50 reviews; daily review replies; weekly partner check-ins; search ads on; first membership drive
Days 90–180	Gate review against the site report's KPIs; adjust the price mix and channels; plan the first signature event

Hub priorities

Hub	Lead audiences	Lead channels	Signature products	Big events
Trivandrum (Kovalam, Vellayani, Varkala, Poovar, Munroe)	Foreign FITs at Kovalam and Varkala; domestic tourists; Thiruvananthapuram residents and Technopark	Google and Tripadvisor; GetYourGuide (capped); resorts at Poovar; Bond Safari cross-sell	Kovalam sunrise SUP; Kappil lake paddle; Munroe canal tour; SUP lessons	Kovalam SUP festival (proposed, December); Academy graduation
Ernakulam (Muziris, Kadamakkudy, Kumbalangi,	Kochi residents; Infopark and SmartCity corporates; houseboat and resort	Corporate sales; houseboat and resort partners;	Kuttanad half-day; Kumarakom bird paddle; Muziris heritage paddle;	Nehru Trophy race week; Vembanad clean-up

Hub	Lead audiences	Lead channels	Signature products	Big events
Kumarakom, Alappuzha, Cherai)	guests; foreign FITs; MICE	Instagram; DMCs	Team Paddle Day	paddle
Kozhikode (Beypore, Kodenchery, Akalapuzha, Pookode)	Kozhikode residents; Gulf diaspora; adventure seekers; Academy learners	Malayalam social and WhatsApp; Gulf-targeted ads; colleges; festivals	Chaliyar river paddle; Kodenchery white-water Academy; monsoon courses	Beypore water festival; Malabar River Festival (arm's length)
Kasaragod depot (Bekal, Parassinikkadavu, Valiyaparamba)	Bekal resort guests; north Kerala residents; domestic tourists	Resort partners (BRDC cluster); local social	Bekal backwater paddle; Valiyaparamba island trail	Bekal beach festival (December)

The Kovalam effect. Kovalam is about half of the Trivandrum hub's spoke earnings and carries Bond's brand. It gets the strongest content production and the Academy story first. It should also host the first international creator trips, because its foreign audience generates the reviews that lift every later site.

9. Marketing calendar

The year at a glance

Months	Who is around	Weather and water	Where the marketing goes
October–November	Domestic post-monsoon travellers; the first foreign arrivals; Diwali holidays	Water full, green, calm after rain	Foreign FIT listings live; domestic Diwali and long-weekend pushes; partner sales kits refreshed
December–January	Peak foreign and domestic travel; Christmas and New Year; migratory birds	Best paddling weather	Maximum capacity; sunrise bird paddles; premium products; reviews
February–March	Foreign peak continues; domestic weekends; corporate year-end offsites	Warming up	Corporate and MICE sales; school annual trips; ITB Berlin
April–May	Indian school holidays; families; Gulf travel planning begins	Hot middays; best early and late	Family packages; sunrise and sunset only; Gulf diaspora pre-sales; Arabian Travel Market
June–August	Gulf diaspora home on	Monsoon:	Diaspora campaign; schools;

Months	Who is around	Weather and water	Where the marketing goes
	holiday; schools in session; corporate weekdays; boat races in August	closures on rough days; sheltered sites only	corporate monsoon formats; Academy courses; calm-water alerts on WhatsApp
September	Onam; domestic holidays; DMC contracting for the season	Monsoon easing	Onam family packages; trade contracting; KTM in its year

The first 18 months

When	Milestones and campaigns
Nov–Dec 2026	Brand system, site pages and Google profiles for Muziris and Kovalam; WhatsApp bot live; Muziris "first season" resident campaign; founding-member offer; creator trips to Muziris
Jan–Mar 2027	Kovalam hub and Academy launch; foreign FIT push at Kovalam (Google, Tripadvisor, GetYourGuide); first Academy intake; ITB Berlin, 16–18 March, with Kerala Tourism or through a DMC partner; Gate 1 review in April
Apr–May 2027	Kadamakkudy, Kumarakom and Alappuzha soft openings; school-holiday family campaign; Gulf diaspora pre-sales for June–August; Arabian Travel Market
Jun–Aug 2027	First monsoon: Kochi corporate monsoon offsites; school programme; diaspora family paddles; Academy monsoon courses; Nehru Trophy race-week presence at Alappuzha. Cash is thinnest in this period, so the monsoon campaign is the most important of the year
Sep 2027	Onam campaign; full opening at Kumarakom and Alappuzha with 20 craft; DMC rate sheets for the 2027–28 season
Oct 2027	Poovar resort pilot; FIT listings live; Diwali push
Nov 2027	WTM London with Kerala Tourism; first Bond Paddle Kerala regatta (Kochi)
Dec 2027–Jan 2028	Peak season; Kumarakom bird paddles; Vembanad clean-up paddle; membership drive for the new year
Feb–Mar 2028	Corporate year-end offsites; school trips; FY29 wave planning (Kumbalangi, Varkala, Munroe, Vellayani, Cherai); launch preparation for the Kozhikode hub

When	Milestones and campaigns
Apr–May 2028	FY29 openings, each following the 90-day launch playbook

The monsoon rule. Every June–September plan needs:

- an approved list of sheltered sites;
- a calm-water alert service;
- a rain-date policy (free rebooking);
- corporate, school and diaspora sales targets set by March.

Marketing never promises a monsoon session that operations cannot run safely.

10. Budget, team and acquisition-cost targets

Where the money comes from

Model V03 has no separate marketing line. Marketing is funded from three places:

- **The 19% site variable cost.** This plan sets aside about 4.5% of site revenue for marketing, and about 7–8% for partner and OTA commissions.
- **The Academy's 15% customer-acquisition allowance on professional courses.** This is already built into the course prices. We assume professional courses are about 60% of Academy revenue.
- **Hub pre-operative budgets.** Each full hub package has ₹13 lakh pre-operative; this plan uses about ₹5 lakh of it for launch marketing.

Marketing budget (₹ lakh, before commissions)

	FY27	FY28	FY29	FY30	FY31
Site marketing (4.5% of site revenue)	2.2	19.5	35.4	46.4	54.5
Academy acquisition (15% of professional course revenue)	2.5	14.3	29.5	45.9	58.1
Total marketing	**4.7**	**33.8**	**64.9**	**92.3**	**112.6**
Launch marketing from hub pre-operative budgets	about 10	—	about 4	—	—
Partner and OTA commissions (paid per sale)	about 4	about 35	about 60	about 74	about 85

FY27 is mostly the Kovalam and Muziris launches, funded largely from the hub pre-operative budgets.
FY27–28 is lean. About ₹34 lakh in FY28 must launch three spokes and run the first monsoon. That is why the plan leans on owned channels, partners and PR rather than paid media.

How the FY28 site marketing budget is split (about ₹19.5 lakh)

Item	Share	₹ lakh

Item	Share	₹ lakh
Search and social ads (Google, Meta, YouTube)	40%	7.8
Content production and creator trips	20%	3.9
Launch events and PR	15%	2.9
Trade: fam trips, rate sheets, Kerala Tourism stands, collateral	10%	2.0
Tools: WhatsApp Business, reviews, CRM add-ons	10%	2.0
Tests and contingency	5%	1.0

From FY29, trade and corporate sales rise to about 20% of the budget, and paid ads fall to about 30% as reviews and search rankings take over.

Acquisition-cost ceilings

Channel	Ceiling per paddler	Rule
Direct digital (ads to website or WhatsApp)	₹120	Pause any campaign above this for two weeks running
Partners (commission)	10–15% of the price	No partner rate above 15%
OTAs	20–30% of the price	Cap at 15% of bookings; same price as our website
DMCs (net rate)	20–25% below retail	Never below the price floor
Academy learners	15% of the course fee	Built into the price
Blended, all channels (FY31)	about ₹140 per paddler	About 11–12% of site revenue per paddler

Team

Role	From	Notes
Head of marketing and sales	FY27	Owns the plan, brand, budget and reporting
Digital marketing executive	FY27	Ads, search, social, WhatsApp, reviews
Corporate and MICE sales lead (Ernakulam hub)	FY28	Part commission
Content creator and photographer, shared across hubs	FY28	Many guides can be trained to shoot good guest photos too
Trade and DMC manager	FY29	Fairs, DMCs, OTAs

Role	From	Notes
Site leads	Each site	Partner relationships, reviews, local events; 10% of their KPIs are marketing

The model covers central salaries in corporate overhead (₹70 lakh in FY28, ₹1.35 Cr in FY31). The first three roles must fit within it, so confirm this against the corporate headcount (9 in FY28) before hiring. An agency retainer is not budgeted; use freelancers for design and video until FY29.

11. Measurement

The funnel we manage

Stage	What we measure	FY28 target	FY31 target
Seen	Google Business Profile views, social reach, OTA impressions	2 M	8 M
Considered	Website sessions, WhatsApp enquiries, partner enquiries	150,000	450,000
Booked	Paddler bookings, by channel and segment	32,800 paddlers	99,300 paddlers
Delighted	Average rating; share of guests leaving a review	4.6+; 8%	4.7+; 10%
Returned	Repeat paddlers and members as a share of paddlers	10%	20%
Laddered	First-time paddlers who start an Academy course	4%	7%

Monthly dashboard (one page, by site and hub)

1. **Volume and revenue:** paddlers, learners and revenue against the model's monthly plan; capacity used.
2. **Mix:** bookings by channel (direct, partner, OTA, B2B) and by segment (resident, Kerala, other states, foreign, corporate, schools).
3. **Cost:** marketing spend; commissions; cost per paddler by channel against the ceilings.
4. **Reputation:** rating and review count on Google and Tripadvisor; replies within 48 hours; complaints and safety incidents.
5. **Loyalty:** new members, repeat rate, WhatsApp list growth.
6. **Partners:** active partners and bookings per partner; commissions paid.
7. **Cross-sell:** referrals to and from other Bond companies, both directions, at the agreed rates.

How we capture it

- **Every booking records a segment and a channel.** The shared booking engine records PIN code or country, channel, partner code and campaign tag (UTM). Walk-ins are logged on a tablet at the kiosk.
- **Each partner has a unique code and QR code,** so commissions and performance are exact.
- **Short guest survey.** One question by WhatsApp after the session: "How did you hear about us?"
- **Monthly review** by the head of marketing with the hub managers. A **quarterly review** goes to the board and investor director, including the related-party cross-sell report.

What triggers action

- **Site below 80% of monthly plan for two months running.** Run a focused campaign and a partner drive. If it is still below plan after the next month, take it to the gate review.
- **OTA share above 15% at a site.** Shift budget to search and partners; raise the website's prominence on Google.
- **Rating below 4.5 at a site.** Stop paid promotion there until service and safety are reviewed.

12. Risks, conflicts and governance

Marketing risks

Risk	Why it matters	How we manage it
A safety incident, or a viral video of one	Adventure brands are judged on safety; one incident would hurt every site	Prepare a crisis communications plan before launch, with one spokesperson, holding statements and fast facts. Never claim "zero risk". Safety proof points must be true on the day they are used
Over-promising in the monsoon	Cancellations produce bad reviews and refunds	Sheltered-site list; free rebooking; only offer what operations confirm
OTA dependence	20–30% commission erodes margin, and the platform owns the customer	15% cap; rate parity; move guests to membership and WhatsApp after the first visit
Price war with ₹299–650 operators (Kavvayi, Alappuzha, Cherai)	Pulls the average ticket below the plan's assumption	Compete on product (SUP, half-days, courses) and on standards; never go below the price floor
Claims we cannot yet back	For example "Paddle UK certified" before the agreement is signed, or "Kerala's first"	Claims are checked by the head of marketing; say "trained to Paddle UK standards" until the agreement is signed

Risk	Why it matters	How we manage it
Influencer non-compliance	ASCI and consumer-protection exposure	Disclosure clause in every brief; post review before publishing; no paid reviews or incentivised Google reviews
Customer data	Phone numbers and WhatsApp lists are personal data	Consent captured at booking; data-sharing agreement between Bond companies; opt-out in every message (Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023)
Over-reach of a small team	Too many channels and sites at once	Launch playbook; at most two openings marketed at the same time

Conflicts and related parties

1. **Cross-selling between Bond companies.**
    - **What happens.** bondsafarikovalam.com (Bond Water Sports and Bond Adventures) and Bond Paddle Sports refer customers to each other, and Bond Membership spans all companies.
    - **The problem.** These are related-party transactions between companies with different shareholders.
    - **The fix.** A written cross-referral agreement at market rates, a reward-cost recharge for the membership, investor-director approval, and quarterly reporting of flows in both directions.
2. **KATPS.**
    - **Registration.** Marketing must not imply official endorsement because the MD sits on the KATPS Technical Committee. The MD recuses himself from every Bond registration.
    - **Festivals.** KATPS co-organises the Malabar River Festival and the Beypore water festival, so Bond's sponsorship or participation must go through the organisers' normal open process, declared and at arm's length.
3. **Government partners.** Listings, festival slots and joint campaigns with Kerala Tourism, DTPCs and Muziris Projects are proposed through the agreed route for government-facing work and through open processes. This must not look like preferential access.
4. **Muziris.**
    - The concession is held by Bond Water Sports until it transfers.
    - Marketing may present Muziris as a Bond Paddle Sports site only once the transfer is completed, or with a clear "operated by" line.
    - The opening dates differ between Bond's records and public reports, so check them before using them in launch copy.
5. **Coastal Blueway.** Until it is decided which company holds the Blueway's paddling, do not market Marari or the Blueway as part of Bond Paddle Sports.

Governance

- The head of marketing owns the plan and the budget. Hub managers own delivery at their sites.
- **Approvals:**

    - any partner commission above 15%;
    - any price below the floor;
    - any campaign spend above ₹2 lakh;
    - all related-party arrangements, which also need the investor director.
- The board sees the dashboard monthly and a full marketing review each quarter.

13. The first 90 days

Weeks	Action	Owner	Done when
1–2	Appoint the head of marketing and sales and a digital executive; agree this plan and the FY28 budget with the board	MD	Roles filled; budget approved
1–4	Brand system: the "Kerala, paddled properly" identity, photo style, a claims checklist, and brief templates with ASCI disclosure	Head of marketing	Brand book approved
1–4	Google Business Profiles verified for Muziris and Kovalam; WhatsApp Business bot live; review-request flow switched on	Digital executive	First 50 reviews requested
2–6	Site pages for Muziris and Kovalam on bondpaddlesports.com, on the shared booking engine, with UTM and partner-code tracking	Web team (Jishamol) and digital executive	Online bookings live
3–6	Founding-member offer and the Muziris resident campaign (Malayalam social, WhatsApp, local press)	Head of marketing	500 founding members
4–8	Kovalam launch pack: FIT listings on GetYourGuide and Viator (capped), a Tripadvisor profile, homestay and guesthouse partners in Kovalam and Vizhinjam, two international creator visits	Head of marketing	Listings and 15 partners live before launch
4–8	Cross-referral agreement with bondsafarikovalam.com, approved by the investor director	MD and investor director	Signed
6–10	Corporate and MICE kit; first 20 Kochi corporate meetings for monsoon 2027 offsites	Corporate sales lead (or MD until hired)	5 pencilled bookings
6–12	DMC rate sheet and safety pack; meetings with the 15 largest Kerala DMCs; plan for ITB Berlin (16–18 March 2027) with Kerala Tourism or a DMC partner	Head of marketing	5 DMCs contracted for 2027–28
8–12	Partner network for the FY28 openings: Alappuzha houseboat owners, Kumarakom resorts,	Hub manager, Ernakulam	40 partner agreements

Weeks	Action	Owner	Done when
	Kadamakkudy homestays		drafted
10–12	First monthly dashboard to the board; school and Gulf-diaspora campaigns for summer 2027 briefed	Head of marketing	Dashboard live

Decisions this plan needs from the board

1. **Budget.** Approve the marketing envelope: 4.5% of site revenue, plus the Academy allowance, plus launch budgets.
2. **Channels.** Approve the 15% cap on OTA bookings, the 10–15% partner commission range and the price floors.
3. **Cross-selling.** Approve the cross-referral agreement and membership recharge between Bond companies.
4. **Hires.** Confirm that the head of marketing, the digital executive and the corporate sales lead fit within corporate overhead.

Sources

- Kerala Tourism Statistics 2025: arrivals by source country and state.
- Kerala Travel Mart 2026, 24–27 September, Kochi.
- Goa Tourism: International events 2026–27: WTM London 3–5 Nov 2026; ITB Berlin 16–18 Mar 2027; Arabian Travel Market Apr–May 2027 (dates tentative).
- Strathcode: OTA commission costs for tour operators (2026): Viator 20%, GetYourGuide 20–30%, Klook 20–25%.
- Kerala Tourism: India's first Wedding and MICE Conclave, Kochi.
- Lulu Retail: Kochi convention centre.
- ASCI influencer advertising guidelines (2025 updates).
- Bond Safari Paddle Sports financial model V03 (3 Nov 2026), the 37 destination feasibility reports, the website design brief and the Bond Membership programme (internal).

Paddler, revenue and budget figures follow model V03, base case. Segment shares, funnel targets and acquisition-cost ceilings are management targets proposed in this plan.